STATUS REPORT

Zimbabwe — digital transformation and data governance status report

Edition of 2026-09-01 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Zimbabwe's digital transformation strategy is recorded as old and in need of updating, with no whole-of-government implementation arrangement behind it, no designated leadership for it and no cross-ministry coordination (2025).

What is on paper is substantial. The Smart Zimbabwe 2030 Master Plan is the overarching digital strategy, built on three pillars — policy, regulation and standards; secure infrastructure; and skills development — and doubles as the national digital payments strategy, while the National ICT Policy 2022-2027 carries e-government and connectivity. The National AI Strategy launched in March 2026 provides for an implementation office, an AI regulatory sandbox and a National Digital Regulatory Committee under POTRAZ, and the government has committed to table a Zimbabwe AI Ethics Framework, with regulatory sandboxes, by the end of the first quarter of 2027.

Institutional readiness is the weaker half. Zimbabwe scored zero on the 2024 Global Index on Responsible AI Governance, two years before the strategy it is now expected to deliver. The GovTech Maturity Index records an established, autonomous data governance institution with no data governance strategy sitting behind it (2025).

The Mo Ibrahim Foundation's 2024 index puts overall governance at 47.1 out of 100, 31st of 54 African states and below the continental average, up 1.6 points over the decade to 2023 but marginally down over the most recent five years, with the country above the continental average on 38 of the index's 96 indicators. Effective administration is the stronger part of that picture at 52.5, 27th of 54, up 10.4 points across the same decade.

Legislation and regulation

Zimbabwe gazetted a 75% citizen-ownership floor and a 25% foreign ceiling on every postal and telecommunications licence on 12 June 2026, with sworn beneficial-ownership affidavits and a POTRAZ veto over any change of ownership.

Underneath sits Statutory Instrument 12 of 2021, made under section 99 of the Postal and Telecommunications Act, which prices a network services licence at US$525,000, then 2% of gross turnover a year and a further 1.5% of monthly gross turnover into the Universal Services Fund. SI 110 of 2023 put commercial couriers on ten-year licences paying into the same fund, exempting the rural-district class from the annual turnover fee. Distributing Starlink terminals requires POTRAZ clearance.

Gazetted on 10 October 2025 and not in force, the Postal and Telecommunications (Amendment) Bill would insert a section 93L requiring a licensee to detain any communication it suspects carries evidence of an offence, or which a commissioned police officer asks it to detain, with handover on the Prosecutor-General's authorisation and no court and no warrant anywhere in the section. The same Bill would designate dominant licensees and oblige them to open their facilities to other licensees — the first facility-access remedy in the statute — and gate the country's orbital resources and the launch of space objects in Zimbabwe's name.

The Cyber and Data Protection Act governs the collection, processing, storage and cross-border transfer of personal data, biometric data included, and the same instrument amends sections 162 to 166 of the Criminal Law (Codification and Reform) Act and inserts a new section 164C, so the compliance regime and the criminal cyber-offences are limbs of one Act. The holes are in the newer subject matter: no AI statute is in force, with an AI Act announced as forthcoming under the National AI Strategy; no law mandates cross-government data sharing or interoperability; and there is no dedicated digital ID law. The Constitution's assignment of the voters' roll to the Zimbabwe Electoral Commission is being reversed in favour of the Registrar-General, the office that already holds the national population database, with no date, transition plan or safeguard stated for the handover as at July 2026.

Data protection

Compliance inspections of data controllers become mandatory on 1 September 2026 under POTRAZ's Regulatory Notice 2 of 2026, moving enforcement of the Cyber and Data Protection Act from registration to inspection. The perimeter is wide: registration is triggered at 50 data subjects, which reaches schools, clinics, churches and any retailer holding a customer list, and section 4 counts merely holding data as processing, so an organisation that keeps a membership list electronically is inside the scheme. Journalistic, historical and archival processing is exempt from the substantive duties but must still register.

The deadlines came first, the enforcement long after. Controllers had to appoint a Data Protection Officer by 12 December 2024 and hold a licence by 13 March 2025 under SI 155 of 2024, which sets 12-month licences in four categories priced US$50, US$300, US$500 and US$2,500 by the number of data subjects held, with a US$30 application fee on the upper three and officer certification at US$1,250. POTRAZ issued the first 570 licences in June 2025; by the launch of the National Cybersecurity Strategy in October 2025 that had reached 721, with 830 officers trained. In March 2026, a year after the licensing deadline lapsed, the regulator warned unlicensed controllers, naming surveillance and biometric processors as in scope.

The fee schedule falls hardest on the smallest holders: mandatory officer certification costs twenty-five times the smallest licence fee, and it does not scale with the volume of data held.

The authority doing this is the telecoms regulator. Section 5 designates POTRAZ the Data Protection Authority as an express statutory provision, and section 6(2) declares it free of direction or control in that role, while its board is appointed by the President and it stays bound by ministerial policy directives. A joint submission to the fourth-cycle Universal Periodic Review in July 2026 names that dual role a structural independence failure, alongside broad national-security exemptions and limited judicial oversight of surveillance. Zimbabwe's digital freedom score fell 5.0 points over the decade to 2023, to 34.1 out of 100 and 44th of 54 African states, its weakest rank in that index's rights measures.

Regional collaboration

Zimbabwe's reach across its borders is physical before it is institutional. Its regional integration score rose 9.0 points over the decade to 2023, to 49.5 out of 100 and 22nd of 54 African states, on a measure of trade, movement and infrastructure rather than of digital instruments; the country sits in both COMESA and SADC.

The clearest cross-border digital link is fibre. Powertel and Paratus have lit the first phase of a corridor from Plumtree to Bulawayo, the Zimbabwean leg of a Botswana–Zimbabwe–Zambia spine, with a second phase northward scheduled. Traffic exchange is more local than the labels suggest: the Harare Internet Exchange Point, built with an African Union grant, had every national access provider connected by October 2020 but only a handful of international peers, and the domestic instant payment switch has no cross-border capability.

What Zimbabwe does export is practice rather than rules. It presented its e-passport and civil registration model to the Annual Expert Group Meeting for African Registrars General and the Africa CRVS Board in July 2026. CIPESA's assessment finds the National AI Strategy's six pillars — talent; infrastructure and computational sovereignty; adoption; governance and ethics; research and development; international collaboration — aligned with the African Union's Continental AI Strategy and Agenda 2063.

Standards

Government systems in Zimbabwe are specified one at a time. The e-Government Technology Unit in the Office of the President and Cabinet named poor connectivity between ministries, departments and agencies and non-standard technical specifications as the chief obstacle to e-government at an ICT standards review held at Kariba in May 2025, and the GovTech Maturity Index records no whole-of-government interoperability framework, and no data-quality or uptime standard applied to government data exchange, as at 2025.

There is also no open-source software policy for government, no governance arrangement for open-source adoption and no route by which open-source suppliers can enter the government market (2025). Where a shared standard does exist it stops at the centre: the standardised budget and financial classification reaches central government only, so spending outside it is not classified to the same chart of accounts. The e-procurement system is the one platform the index records as enforcing standards on what is procured.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

The GovTech Maturity Index records no e-participation platform in Zimbabwe, with all six of its citizen participation indicators absent (2025); the one channel it does find in operation is a citizen feedback mechanism that reaches government and draws a response.

Argument happens anyway, in Parliament and in the press. Legislators challenged the Starlink rollout in May 2026 on affordability and sovereignty grounds, with the ICT Minister defending the entry as pro-competition. The Home Affairs Minister told the Senate that same month that he was not aware of any backlog in passports, birth certificates and national identity documents and was hearing of it for the first time. Harare's chief traffic officer has said motorists must be informed well before laws are gazetted and certainly before enforcement commences, to avoid perceptions of entrapment, and has recommended a non-penal trial phase for the city's AI traffic cameras to fix technical faults, refine signage and test appeals pathways before penalties apply.

The space to argue is narrower than the volume of argument suggests. Media freedom scores 45.5 out of 100 and 37th of 54 African states in the 2024 Ibrahim Index, and freedom of expression and belief 41.7 and 39th, both flat or slightly down over the decade to 2023. A legal analysis published in August 2026 reads the Cyber and Data Protection Act's section 11(1) consent requirement as demanding a data subject's written consent before naming them in reporting on a rape trial, a public figure's hospitalisation or an abduction, and concludes that rigorous application would suppress most investigative journalism; the same Act carries the criminal cyber-offence provisions in the same instrument as the compliance regime.

Little of the digital government estate is published for anyone to argue with, from the strategy documents to the data protection authority's own reporting, though disclosure of public records is among the country's most improved governance indicators over the decade to 2023, with accessibility of those records near-flat.

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

Zimbabwe had signed no memorandum of understanding or comparable non-binding digital cooperation agreement as at August 2026.

New investments

Zimbabwe's two Chinese state telecoms loans are cross-collateralised: where TelOne's debt-service reserve account at China Eximbank falls short, the agreement directs surplus revenues from the separately financed third phase of the NetOne expansion to settle the TelOne loan. That credit is a US$98.6 million preferential buyer's credit ratified by Parliament on 5 April 2016 and repayable to January 2037, and the government on-lent it at a higher rate than it pays China Eximbank, covering most of a US$116.8 million Huawei equipment contract, with the state-owned NetOne as guarantor.

Six digital-sector commitments are on the record, announced between 2015 and 2023, with delivery running out to 2027 and repayments to 2037. They come to roughly half a billion US dollars, nearly all of it Chinese state finance — China Development Bank, China Eximbank and the Ministry of Commerce — with Sweden the only other financier. Four of the six are loans and two grants, so this is debt rather than aid, and connectivity takes the great majority against much smaller sums for university computing and digital skills. The largest, approved in 2015, is not recorded as moving, and two more are closed.

That is a US$300 million loan from China Development Bank and ZTE Corporation to Econet Wireless Zimbabwe, agreed on 4 December 2015 for market consolidation and new services. China Eximbank has also extended a concessional loan for Phase 3 of NetOne's expansion, the state-owned operator whose network build has been Chinese-financed and Huawei-equipped since 2G (2021).

The rest is small. The University of Zimbabwe's high-performance computing centre, financed by a RMB 33 million Chinese interest-free loan and built by Inspur Group, was handed over on 6 February 2015, and China's Ministry of Commerce granted RMB 100 million for a second phase from 2018, intended to raise its capacity almost tenfold. Sweden's Sida is funding a SEK 36 million Plan International programme teaching digital skills to secondary and vocational students to 2026.

Domestically, a National AI Innovation Fund to finance and mentor AI start-ups, to be pursued with the telecoms operators, was planned but not established as at March 2026.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Fewer than half as many Zimbabweans use the internet as the headline penetration rate implies. POTRAZ put internet penetration at 84.55% at the end of 2025, a ratio of 13,252,877 active internet and data subscriptions to population rather than a count of users, while 38.4% of Zimbabweans used the internet in 2025; unique mobile subscriber penetration ran at around 80% against connections at about 95% of the population.

Coverage divides by generation and by settlement. 5G reached 18.9% of the population and none of the rural areas at the end of 2025, across 366 base stations, where 3G reached 73.7% of rural areas. Econet ran 7,143 base stations at the end of 2025, 340 of them 5G — more than NetOne and Telecel combined — and carried 73.75% of subscribers and about 81.2% of data traffic in a quarter when data first passed half of mobile operator revenue. The national fibre backbone stood at 14,357 km at the end of 2025, with Liquid Intelligent Technologies holding 32.3%, TelOne 28.2% and Powertel 26.9%.

Price, not reach, decides who is on. Mobile data is among the least affordable in the region, and POTRAZ approved a roughly 35% rise in ZiG-denominated bundle tariffs in May 2025. Starlink, licensed on 6 September 2024 and live the same day, pushed fixed broadband past half wireless — 54.54% — as its lines rose from about 30,900 to 67,000 over 2025, but adoption clustered on Harare and Bulawayo rooftops rather than the rural areas it was pitched at, because pricing is in US dollars. Legislators challenged the rollout in May 2026 as prices moved from US$65 to more than US$100, and more than 400 kits donated to rural health facilities sat unactivated in July 2026 because the health ministry cannot afford the subscriptions, the Universal Services Fund covering subscriptions only for digital centres and schools, for one year.

That fund's position is not published: the Auditor-General issued unmodified opinions on it for 2023 and 2024 while stating no balance, no contribution total and no disbursement figure. Government arrears to TelOne doubled to about US$42m by June 2026, holding back its capital spending, even as its revenue from reselling Starlink rose from US$215,000 to US$3.7m.

Data Storage

Zimbabwe's National AI Strategy mandates a Sovereign National Cloud to end the holding of national and commercial data in foreign clouds, with agricultural predictive models and geological and mineral maps to sit on domestic servers. It is a mandate issued into an estate with no direct hyperscale cloud on-ramp, served from the nearest regional availability zone in Johannesburg, and with Google and Microsoft cloud services delivered locally through partnership rather than in-country infrastructure.

Government's own arrangements are undocumented. There was no government cloud platform, no policy governing where government data may be hosted, and no disclosure of the hosting behind the systems the state runs (2025). What exists is commitment: a National Data Centre ecosystem is one of five undertakings set out under Smart Zimbabwe 2030 (July 2026), and the strategy designates high-performance computing centres as national assets rather than a procured service.

Commercial capacity has moved faster than state capacity. Africa Data Centres and Econet commissioned a 5MW facility in Harare in June 2025, with redundant power, multi-carrier connectivity and hyperscaler partnerships with Google and Microsoft, a materially higher grade than the earlier TelOne site, and Econet InfraCo has announced a 300-hectare industrial and IT park near Harare airport pairing 100 MW of solar generation with an AI-ready data centre (January 2026).

Where sovereignty is claimed, the underlying compute is often someone else's. The cloud Econet AI offers government draws its GPU capacity from Cassava Technologies' AI factory (April 2026), and Liquid C2, part of the same Zimbabwean group, opened Africa's first Google Cloud Partner Experience Centre in Johannesburg rather than in Zimbabwe (June 2026). The one binding rule on location is statutory rather than strategic: the Cyber and Data Protection Act restricts transfers of personal data outside Zimbabwe unless adequate protection is demonstrated, and requires notification to the Data Protection Authority under sections 28 and 29.

Energy

Only 14% of Zimbabweans described their electricity supply as reliable in Afrobarometer's 2024 survey, with daily outages reported as long as 18 hours. Access is the improving half of the picture and reliability is not: access to energy is the country's fastest-improving infrastructure measure in the Ibrahim Index, up 9.1 points over 2014-2023 to 38.8 out of 100 and 28th of 54 African states, a measure of households connected rather than hours supplied. The connection itself still splits by settlement, reaching 84% of the urban population against 51.4% of the rural population in 2023.

Renewables supplied 45.86% of generation in 2023, a share carried by hydro and so by the rain. The National Renewable Energy Policy provides for off-grid deployment, pay-as-you-go solar and mini-grid partnerships, and residential electricity is priced in US dollars by the regulator.

The digital economy's response has been to leave the grid rather than wait for it. Econet InfraCo is applying AI to predictive generator maintenance, fuel optimisation and base-station reliability across its towers, and deployed 90 new base stations in the quarter to May 2026 — network reliability work that is substantially about diesel. Its PowerCo arm has begun construction on the first phase of a 100MW solar farm for Econet Tech City in Harare, a development slated to contain a data centre, and also supplies other commercial users (May 2026).

Technical Capacity

Where the state builds, it largely buys. The identity estate depends heavily on foreign vendors for elections biometrics, for passport and border biometrics, and for data centre infrastructure and facial recognition, with ID and passport card production outsourced to a private printer, while the Registrar-General's Office and POTRAZ continue to run the core population registry in-country (2023).

The administrative base under that has been improving. Effective administration rose 10.4 points over 2014-2023 to 52.5 out of 100 and 27th of 54 African states, within a public administration sub-category scoring 48.4, and the capacity of the statistical system is among the country's most improved measures of the decade. None of it is yet showing in what the state delivers online: Zimbabwe's UN E-Government Development Index score for 2024 was 0.4481, ranking it 149th of 193 states.

Running shared national infrastructure is a thinner record than building it. All national internet access providers were connected to the Harare Internet Exchange Point by October 2020, but only two international peers had joined, leaving a nominally regional exchange working as a national one, and the regulator itself proposed merging it with the separate Zimbabwe Internet Exchange and handing management to the technical community. The graduate pipeline behind all of this runs through several established public universities offering computer science, engineering and other ICT degrees, where STEM is a minority of total intake.

Cybersecurity

Zimbabwe scored 39.86 out of 100 on the ITU Global Cybersecurity Index 2024, in the 'Evolving' tier, against 36.49 in 2020 — four years for three points, on an index that measures published commitments rather than defended systems. The strategy behind that score cannot be pinned down. The ICT ministry announced on 15 October 2025 that the National Cybersecurity Strategy had been completed, and the same minister said on 2 July 2026 that the ministry is finalising a National Cybersecurity Strategy for 2026-2030, anchored on a proposed National Cybersecurity Authority to coordinate incident response and protect critical information infrastructure. No strategy document is on the record at either date, and no authority has been constituted. The institution behind it, the Cyber Security Centre, is established by the Cyber and Data Protection Act, which puts the national cybersecurity body and the data protection regime in a single statute.

Breach duties are short and run to the regulator first: controllers must report a breach to POTRAZ within 24 hours and notify affected data subjects within 72 hours where high risk applies.

Assurance over the state's largest personal-data estate is not on the public record. No regular independent security audit, penetration test or privacy impact assessment of the identity system has been published, despite civil society recommending such assessments ahead of expanded biometric deployment (2023).

The sharpest defence anywhere in the record is aimed at insiders. The digital deeds instrument makes logins on the system traceable, creating a digital footprint for anyone dealing with a given property, and carries criminal sanctions explicitly targeting Registry or government employees who collude with or assist fraudsters — a design that follows from an original deed stolen from the Deeds Registry itself, fraudulently altered with the help of an internal official and used to sell a Harare property, the fraudster later convicted.

DPI

Data Exchange

Zimbabwe's only working cross-government data exchange belongs to the tax authority: since December 2023 the Tax and Revenue Management System has been connected through an Enterprise Bus to the Registrar of Companies, the Deeds Office, the Civil Registry and selected banks, validating national identity and company registration numbers online at the point of taxpayer registration, with further ministry and agency connections added from October 2024. The Fiscalisation Data Management System joined it from a December 2025 cut-off, with input tax pre-populated automatically from January 2026, while integration with the customs system ASYCUDA remains unfinished.

Above it there is nothing. UNCTAD's 2025 assessment found the siloism of government departments and systems preventing seamless data exchange, with the ZimConnect e-services portal no substitute, and no law obliging one ministry to share data with another.

Connections exist without a framework. The World Bank's 2025 GovTech Maturity Index records the main back-office systems — financial management, tax, customs, human resources, debt and procurement — as exchanging data with other government systems, and records no interoperability framework, no data-quality or uptime standard for government data exchange, no programme to retire legacy systems onto a common standard and no published exchange or data-sovereignty terms.

The population register reaches further than any published rule governs: it is connected by wide area network to pension offices, immigration, the police, motor vehicle registration and mobile network operators, with the National Registration Act limiting disclosure to court order and the Cyber and Data Protection Act setting only general conditions on transfer and consent.

The health ministry's FHIR-based Zimbabwe Core Implementation Guide is a draft in continuous development, with no cross-agency health data exchange operating. Employment data stays fragmented across the labour ministry, ZIMSTAT, ZIMRA and NSSA, with no central repository and no data-sharing policy among the producers. Reach is also geographic: ZimConnect has no documented provincial or local government participation, and the National Broadband Plan launched in March 2024 to widen rural connectivity is only in early implementation. Open API standards for public-sector platforms were announced as an intention at the launch of the Ndarama government ERP in July 2026.

Digital Identity and CRVS

The money for paper ran out: a funding shortfall halted issuance of national IDs and birth certificates across Zimbabwe, the Registrar-General's Department unable to pay for printing consumables (2026). The ministry concedes the birth-certificate problems and puts them down to funding and resource constraints, while the Home Affairs Minister told the Senate in May 2026 that he "was not aware" of any backlog in passports, birth certificates and national identity documents.

Registration is compulsory under section 6 of the National Registration Act for every resident aged 16 or over who has lived in the country for six months, non-citizens included, and the card is required for banking, SIM registration, voting, healthcare, employment and passport applications. Registration is free only between 16 and 18: after 18 it costs US$2, and replacement or corrected documents US$5 to US$30 (2024).

The 2022 census found 87.9% of people aged 16 and above had ever been issued a national identity document, 92.0% urban against 84.9% rural, and around 21.1% of those aged 16 to 34, roughly 952,000 young people, held none.

The record has been digital for three decades — the Zimbabwe Population Registration System has stored fingerprints, facial images and biographic data electronically since 1996 — but the foundational digital identity built on it has not launched nationally: the reformed registry was being introduced in Harare and Bulawayo only as of mid-2025, with extension to the rest of the country not yet under way. There is no dedicated digital ID law: the National Registration Act predates digital identity and the Cyber and Data Protection Act is a general statute. No independent security audit, penetration test or privacy impact assessment of the identity system has been published.

Enrolment in remote districts is carried by mobile teams rather than digitised rural registry offices. The estate leans on foreign suppliers — Laxton for election biometrics, Garsu Pasaulis for passport and border biometrics, Inspur and CloudWalk for data centre infrastructure and facial recognition, with card production outsourced to a private printer under a build-operate-transfer arrangement — while the Registrar-General's Office and POTRAZ run the core registry.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Zimbabwe carried 511.1 million electronic transactions worth ZiG1.37 trillion in the first half of 2026, and the Reserve Bank's own reading is that the binding constraint is no longer whether digital options exist but whether they are trusted, affordable, reliable and accepted, naming network reliability, digital literacy, cybersecurity awareness and merchant acceptance in the informal sector as the barriers. Only a small fraction of the payment cards issued in the country are in active use, and almost all transport fares are still paid in cash.

ZIPIT, launched in 2011 and running nationwide, links bank accounts and mobile wallets including EcoCash across domains, with ZIPIT 3.0 live from early 2024. It settles over the central bank's RTGS rail on a deferred net T+1 basis, and the Reserve Bank both shapes the scheme's appointments, product approvals and pricing and took a 15% stake in Zimswitch in 2020. Two things it does not carry: cross-border transactions, and government-to-person payments, which route instead through ZEEPAY and take around ten minutes. Its scheme rules are confidential and unpublished.

The wallet competition has turned physical. EcoCash has wired cash withdrawals into TN CyberTech Bank's ATM network; InnBucks has installed ten of its own cash-recycler ATMs at Simbisa Brands outlets, with 78 more in the pipeline; and O-Mari, the Old Mutual and CABS wallet, lets holders draw cash at CABS ATMs through interbank settlement without deploying a single new machine (July 2026). State-owned NetOne's One Wallet remains unactivated, and a possible integration with AFC Holdings that would extend mobile money to farming communities has not moved.

The Reserve Bank set up a dedicated Digital Transformation and Fintech department in November 2025, carrying a regulatory sandbox, an Innovation Hub and the second National Financial Inclusion Strategy. The 2026 Monetary Policy Statement raised ZIPIT and mobile money limits from ZiG 8,000 to ZiG 13,000 and capped bank charges at 2% on withdrawals and 1.5% on point-of-sale transactions, with enforcement of the caps limited. The ZiG is legal tender and still fails routinely at online checkout, where the main gateways — Paynow, Pesapal and DPO — are configured USD-first.

Registries

Zimbabwe is abolishing the paper title deed. Statutory Instrument 76 of 2025, gazetted on 18 July 2025, creates a class of "securitised deeds" to replace it, and existing deeds must be validated and securitised into a digital registry over a 24-month transition, with a nationwide validation programme under way. Once the window closes only securitised deeds will be valid for legal and administrative purposes, unless the Minister extends the transition by notice in the Gazette. Sixteen law firms were selected in April 2026 for a Title Deed Validation and Reissuance Pilot testing the Digital Land Administration Platform, the operational system behind the scheme.

One case drove it: the deed of Dr Dzingai Mutumbuka, Zimbabwe's first black Minister of Education, was stolen from the Deeds Registry itself, fraudulently altered with an official's help and used to sell his Chisipite property while he was abroad.

What the registers miss matters more. ZIMSTAT's 2024/25 Economic Census found only 23.9% of 204,798 business establishments registered with the Registrar of Companies, ZIMRA or NSSA, formality near-universal among large establishments but around 19% among micro-enterprises. The migration of the register itself has slipped. Statutory Instrument 108 of 2025 set 20 April 2026 as the date by which companies registered before the electronic registry must re-register or be automatically deregistered, and three days before it fell due that date was deleted and 20 April 2028 substituted. No count of entities re-registered has been published at either date. Civil registration is computerised across all ten provinces and 63 districts but at only more than 20 of 209 sub-offices, leaving the local layer largely on paper. Birth registration remains well short of universal, and rural residence is still a significant predictor of a child's birth going unregistered.

Two registers are being built new. ZIMSTAT and the labour ministry are constructing a Zimbabwe Social Registry, with a household survey running since October 2025 and a live pilot in Nkayi district ahead of phased extension to all 65 districts. The first phase of enumeration completed in Mangwe district in December 2025 and extends to Nkayi and Mudzi, aiming at about 2% of the population or roughly 80,000 households, with a proposed second phase adding at least a further 4% and a funded IT component covering integration with civil registry systems and server hosting. The Surveyor General's eCadastre portal offers nationwide online search of land parcels by owner, property ID or deed number, separately from the Deeds Registry that records legal title, with some properties still requiring manual enquiry.

The Electoral Commission registered about 6.62 million voters for the August 2023 elections, around 71% of an estimated voting-age population, on a biometric system with deduplication and online inspection of the roll; custody of that roll is moving to the Registrar-General, which already holds the population database.

Sectoral management information systems

Health is the deepest deployment: Zimbabwe's Impilo electronic health record was running at 1,254 of roughly 1,900 public health facilities — about two thirds — as of August 2025, with further expansion under way, and the National eHealth Strategy is extending solar power, internet connectivity and digital diagnostics to last-mile rural facilities. Installation is running ahead of working systems: in Matabeleland South, the share of facilities with the infrastructure installed stood well above the share with it fully functional in the first half of 2025, with rural districts held back by unreliable electricity and connectivity. Donated satellite kits sit unactivated at rural health facilities because the health ministry cannot afford the subscriptions.

Education runs a system without joining it up. Plans to merge the Teacher Development Information System with the national Education Management Information System and to decentralise data capture to schools remain in progress rather than realised, and the 2025 annual school census form still asks each primary school whether it maintains digitalised school records. Education is not an integrated use case of any national data exchange.

The Judiciary's Integrated Electronic Case Management System is the most digitally advanced sector system in government, and is connected to no national interoperability platform. The Chief Justice told the opening of the 2026 legal year that all the superior courts are now paperless and four magisterial provinces had been digitised under the fourth phase of the rollout, and sixteen further magistrates' courts in Manicaland and Mashonaland East were set for digitisation from 1 June 2026. No case volume or disposal-time figure from the system has been published. At the other end, rural police stations record criminal cases and complaints entirely on paper dockets, with an electronic docket system still described as forthcoming in December 2025.

The core systems are live and mostly bought in. The tax and customs administration systems are both in use and both built on commercial off-the-shelf software; the public-service human resources system runs on commercial software while the government payroll runs on separately built custom software; the social insurance and pension system runs on commercial software with a separate scheme for public employees and is the one core government system recorded as not interoperating with any other.

Over the top of all of it, Zimbabwe launched Ndarama, a whole-of-government ERP covering finance, human resources, supply chain and assets, at the Harare Institute of Technology on 29 July 2026, presented as the clean public data lake that government AI would need.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

A citizen can complete nothing on Zimbabwe's national public service portal: the GovTech Maturity Index rates it informational, publishing information about services rather than letting anyone transact, and a business cannot be formed or registered through it. The sectoral portals are where the state is reachable — the tax portal, the social protection portal and the government jobs portal are all in use and all recorded as reaching ordinary users (2025).

The tax portal supports registration, filing and payment, and the social protection portal registration, benefits and payment. ZIMRA runs E-Services for registration and E-Taxes for filing, viewing returns and checking compliance status, and its self-service portal issues the Taxpayer Identification Number that gates e-filing, e-payments and automated tax clearance. Companies register and update their records through the CIPZ online portal. Biometric passports and ID cards can be applied for online, though biometric capture still means a visit in person.

Behind the counter it is fuller: a financial management information system covering central and local government, an e-procurement system covering online tendering and contract management, and debt and public investment management systems in use. An institution exists with a mandate to coordinate digital government across the administration, and nothing about its work is published, along with the digital transformation strategy, the data governance documents, the cloud hosting arrangements and the service portal's own terms. There is no e-participation platform at all.

What citizens say about the experience is worse than any of it. Zimbabweans' reported ease of obtaining an identity document scores 4.4 out of 100, the lowest of all 96 Ibrahim Index indicators for the country and down 23.2 points over 2014-2023. The UN E-Government Development Index put Zimbabwe at 0.4481 for 2024, 149th of 193 states.

The GovTech Maturity Index's Zimbabwe record divides by function rather than by degree: of its 149 data points, 55 record something as absent and 54 as present, with the positives concentrated in back-office systems — financial management, tax, customs, payroll, human resources, debt, procurement, social insurance — and the negatives concentrated in citizen participation, open data, transparency, interoperability, open source and innovation.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

Zimbabwe's civil registration is computerised across all 10 provinces and all 63 districts but at only more than 20 of its 209 sub-offices as at July 2026 — under a tenth of the layer of offices closest to the people who use them. The pattern holds above it: ZimConnect is a national portal with no documented provincial or local government participation, and data exchange and e-service reach are concentrated in Harare and Bulawayo, with the National Broadband Plan 2020-2030, launched in March 2024 to address that, only in early implementation (2025).

Money is the one layer where the national system formally reaches down. Zimbabwe's financial management information system, built on commercial off-the-shelf software, is in use and covers both central and local government (2025), but its standardised budget and financial classification reaches central government only, so spending outside the centre is not classified to the same chart of accounts (2025).

What sub-national government has built for itself is municipal and unconnected. Harare City Council is rolling out its own Electronic Traffic Management System across the central business district, using automated detection, evidence capture and e-ticketing against speeding, red-light running, illegal turns and congestion — a system distinct from the national police programme announced the same day (August 2026). Its chief traffic officer has recommended a non-penal trial phase to fix technical faults, refine signage and test appeals pathways before financial penalties apply.

Provision for the rest of local government has come as hardware rather than as systems: the government donated 250 Starlink kits to local authorities under its digitisation drive (July 2025). The books underneath are largely unautomated. Auditing the 2024 financial year, the Auditor-General found most local authorities lagging in technology, their business processes still manual or partially automated, with modules of their accounting systems left unactivated and the resulting late submission of financial statements compromising document retention (June 2025), and most councils without an enterprise resource planning system for revenue collection, so recognising revenue on a cash basis for want of complete databases and losing revenue as a result; revenue-collection and debt-recovery findings rose from 81 across 51 local authorities to 92 across 60.

Rural digital data capture

Outside health, the record a rural public office generates is still made on paper. Rural police stations record criminal cases and complaints entirely on paper dockets and registers, and as at December 2025 the Zimbabwe Republic Police still described its electronic docket management system as forthcoming rather than deployed; a 2021 government pledge to provide internet connectivity to rural police stations came first. Primary schools in Mutoko district report no access to digital tools for administrative data entry, gathering information on paper for transcription at higher administrative levels (2025).

Health is the exception. The Impilo electronic health record had been deployed at the majority of public health facilities by August 2025, though Starlink kits donated to rural health facilities are sitting unactivated because the health ministry cannot meet the subscriptions (July 2026).

Where registration reaches remote districts it arrives as an expedition rather than as infrastructure. The Civil Registry Department, with UNICEF and the Embassy of Sweden, ran a mobile identity and birth registration drive in Binga district from 7 to 11 July 2025, reaching villages some 160 km from Binga Centre over journeys of up to seven hours on poor roads and with wildlife risk. The reformed population registry system behind the planned digital ID rollout was being introduced in Harare and Bulawayo only as at July 2025.

The World Bank's country diagnostic of the digital economy named the constraint in 2021: poor rural internet and electricity access, with limited device availability, hold back digital adoption in rural public offices. Neither rural network reach nor rural electricity access has since caught up with its urban equivalent.

Digital capture that does reach the countryside is sectoral: a farmer registry run with FAO and a biometric register of cotton farmers modelled on the tobacco board's enrol producers one commodity at a time. The rural economy is Zimbabwe's second best-performing governance area, at 70.8 out of 100 in 2023 after the largest decade gain of any of the index's sub-categories for the country, with rural market access the one component to deteriorate, down 10.8 points over 2014-2023.

Technology

AI

Zimbabwe's National Artificial Intelligence Strategy 2026–2030 commits the state to a federated National AI and Data Platform, sharing data across ministries through privacy-preserving APIs, with sector-level pilots beneath it; President Mnangagwa launched it at the new parliament building at Mount Hampden on 13 March 2026. The strategy provides for an AI Strategy Implementation Office, a regulatory sandbox for AI and a National Digital Regulatory Committee under the telecoms regulator POTRAZ, and mandates a sovereign national cloud for data now held abroad. None of it is law: a National AI Act is announced as forthcoming and has not been enacted. Measured in 2024, before the strategy existed, Zimbabwe registered no responsible-AI governance at all on the Global Index on Responsible AI Governance, and CIPESA reads implementation rather than design as the binding constraint.

Most of what is actually running belongs to a private operator rather than to the state. Econet AI launched in April 2026, offering a stated sovereign cloud for government and Shona local-language AI alongside its Yamurai and OmniContact products. Inside government, the Procurement Regulatory Authority has put AI tools into its electronic government procurement system, operational since January 2024. Two traffic-enforcement systems are being installed in parallel: the Zimbabwe Republic Police have cameras at signalised intersections under the Smart Policing Programme, with a nationwide AI-based traffic management system not yet commissioned (August 2026), and Harare City Council is separately rolling out its own automated detection, evidence capture and e-ticketing across the central business district (August 2026). The groundwork the strategy assumes is later than the strategy: Ndarama, the whole-of-government ERP presented in July 2026, is offered as the clean public data that government AI would work from, and Shona and Ndebele language corpora are to be built by Zimbabwean universities with money ring-fenced from the Universal Services Fund (July 2026).

ICT Industry

A business cannot be formed or registered through Zimbabwe's national service portal (2025), which leaves the state's digital front door closed to the firms a domestic technology sector would be built from, against a business population that is largely unregistered anywhere. There is no startup law or state programme behind a domestic supplier market, entry to network services is priced by a licence fee and recurring turnover levies fixed in statute, and an ownership floor gazetted in June 2026 was withdrawn inside the same quarter. The market that exists is dominated by a single private group.

Innovation ecosystem

No externally tracked venture capital reached Zimbabwean startups in 2025, after some in 2024, and the country ranked 118th on WIPO's Global Innovation Index in 2024.

The state runs no innovation machinery of its own. As at 2025 there was no startup law or programme, and no financing or small-business support attached to one; no public-sector innovation programme, no innovation lab or fund, and no mechanism for public-private collaboration on public-sector innovation; and no open-source software policy, nor any route by which open-source suppliers can enter the government market. The AI strategy's own sandbox and implementation office are provided for on paper rather than operating.

What innovation capacity exists sits outside the executive. A number of technology and innovation hubs are running, among them Impact Hub Harare (2025); a government-backed National Venture Capital Company of Zimbabwe exists to finance domestic startups (2025); and the financial regulator is the one arm of the state with working innovation plumbing, the Reserve Bank having established a Digital Transformation and Fintech department carrying a regulatory sandbox and an innovation hub (November 2025). The most substantial new product of the period came from an operator rather than from any of that, in Econet's AI launch of April 2026.

Capacity

Literacy

Zimbabwe's schools are better staffed than they are filled. The Mo Ibrahim Foundation's governance index, which scores African states on the public goods they actually deliver, put the country's human resources in education at 92.4 out of 100 in 2023, 12th of 54 states and a point higher than a decade earlier, while education enrolment — the weakest component of the same measure — scored 39.8 and ranked 28th, pulling the education score down 4.4 points over 2014–2023 to 57.9 and 21st place. The measure covers teacher supply and qualification, so a strong score there is compatible with classrooms that have neither equipment nor a digital curriculum. The narrowing continues past school: tertiary gross enrolment stood at around 9.7% of the eligible age group (2020), which caps the pipeline into technical education whatever the standing of the institutions at the top of it.

For adults already out of the classroom, the question is whether they can use a digital service at all, and the government's own diagnosis is that this is now the binding part. The Reserve Bank of Zimbabwe names digital literacy, alongside network reliability, cybersecurity awareness and merchant acceptance in the informal sector, as what now decides whether digital payments are used rather than merely available (July 2026). There is now a number behind that. The 2025 household ICT survey found 43.7% of Zimbabweans holding basic digital skills, alongside 31% of internet users reporting use of AI applications (July 2026) - the first national measurement of the skill itself rather than of access to the thing it is used on. The stated remedy runs through the regulator: POTRAZ and the national innovation hubs are to scale AI literacy, with coding taught from secondary level (July 2026), and the named national programme, a 1.5 million coders initiative, opened free registration and modules in programming, AI basics, Android development and data science in September 2025. No enrolment or completion count has been published against that target.

Training and skills

Zimbabwe's account of its own public-service digital skills provision is that it is a programme rather than a function. The World Bank's 2025 GovTech assessment records a digital skills programme for public servants covering basic skills, with the training open beyond the civil service, but standing as a strategy or programme rather than an established training arm, and the strategy itself is not published. Skills development is one of the three pillars of the Smart Zimbabwe 2030 Master Plan, the overarching digital strategy, alongside policy and secure infrastructure.

The tertiary pipeline is real but narrow at the top. The University of Zimbabwe, the National University of Science and Technology in Bulawayo, Midlands State University, Chinhoyi University of Technology and the dedicated Harare Institute of Technology all offer computer science, engineering and other ICT degrees, but STEM has been a small minority of total university intake (2020). Onto that base the state has loaded an ambition: the Heritage-Based Education 5.0 model is assigned the job of producing the AI specialists the National AI Strategy requires.

Where training has produced counted output it has been in data protection rather than digital skills generally, with the numbers of licensed data controllers and trained data protection officers both rising into the launch of the National Cybersecurity Strategy (October 2025). Youth skills provision leans on donors: Sweden is financing Plan International's digital skills programme for young people in secondary and vocational education, teaching digital literacy, coding and employability skills to 2026. At the other end, the labour market has a working front door — the government jobs portal is in use and handles registration, search and applications, carrying public-sector and private vacancies alike (2025).

Research institutions

Zimbabwe's one substantial piece of research computing was built and paid for by China. The high-performance computing centre at the University of Zimbabwe was completed by Inspur Group with Dameng and handed to the university on 6 February 2015, with Zimbabwean researchers trained to run it for agriculture, weather forecasting, mining, gene technology and simulation. China's Ministry of Commerce then financed a second phase, intended to raise the machine from 36 teraflops per second to over 300 and to add cloud services, again with Inspur as contractor and implementation beginning in 2018.

Output has not followed the hardware. Zimbabwe ranked 118th on WIPO's Global Innovation Index in 2024, the composite that scores countries on research and innovation inputs and on what they produce from them. The universities that would carry any domestic research effort are the established public institutions offering computer science and engineering, into which STEM has drawn a small minority of intake (2020), and the same Education 5.0 model is the instrument named for producing the country's AI specialists. The first concrete research task assigned to them is linguistic: Zimbabwean universities are to build Shona and Ndebele language corpora for AI, part-financed from the Universal Services Fund (July 2026).

Inclusion

Access to services

A card the state cannot currently print is the condition of nearly everything else. The national registration card is the legally recognised proof of identity, required for banking, SIM registration, voting, healthcare, social services, employment and a passport, and is demanded in practice at the clinic and on registration for cash transfers even where no law makes it a condition — so the halt in printing identity cards and birth certificates in 2026, which the Home Affairs Ministry put down to funding and resources in May 2026, closes a door on each of them at once.

Obtaining one is what Zimbabweans rate worst of all: ease of getting an identity document is the lowest-scoring of all 96 Ibrahim Index indicators for the country in 2023. The counter is paper. An applicant must present physical documents — identity cards, hospital birth records, witness statements, or a letter from a village head or farmer; registration is free only between 16 and 18 and charged in US dollars after that; and computerisation covers every province and district but barely touches the sub-office layer where most people are served. Where fixed offices are out of reach, mobile registration teams have carried enrolment to remote districts such as Binga, a temporary substitute for a standing service.

The digital channel does not yet stand in for the counter. The national public service portal publishes information about services rather than letting a citizen complete them as at 2025. Digital payment channels are effectively unusable by visually impaired people without another person's help. Civil registration law does not distinguish citizens from non-citizens, yet refugee and stateless populations, particularly children born in camps, remain incompletely registered.

Taken together the state scores 24.7 out of 100 on equal access to public services in 2023, 44th of 54 African states, a figure that has drifted down over the preceding decade within an Inclusion and Equality score itself 3.8 points lower at 42.2. The exception is money, where access to banking services is the country's most improved governance indicator of the decade.

Digital divides

Price, not reach, is Zimbabwe's sharpest line of exclusion: a 2GB mobile broadband plan cost 18.4% of GNI per capita in 2022, against the 2% international affordability target, and that was already a steep fall from 30.0% the year before. The regulator's headline penetration rate counts subscriptions against population at the end of 2025, and the share who actually used the internet in 2025 is under half of it; the same pattern runs through payments, where the great majority of cards issued are not in active use.

The rural side of that line is drawn by more than the network. Electricity access still splits sharply between town and countryside, 5G had reached none of the rural population at the end of 2025, and e-service reach is concentrated on Harare and Bulawayo. Satellite broadband, pitched at the countryside, was taken up on rooftops in those same cities, being priced in US dollars, and donated satellite kits at rural health facilities sit unactivated because the health ministry cannot meet the subscriptions. Mobile money has not filled the gap: a state-owned wallet remains unactivated and the integration that would have carried it into farming communities has stalled.

Exclusion from the register compounds all of it. A large minority of Zimbabweans aged 16 to 34 held no national identity document at the 2022 census, coverage was lower in rural areas than urban, the issuing backlog falls hardest on rural provinces, and children without a birth certificate are being refused enrolment in school as at May 2026.

The gendered line is the one moving fastest in the wrong direction. Women's access to public services scored 22.6 out of 100 in 2023, 44th of 54 African states, down 8.7 points over the preceding decade and among Zimbabwe's ten worst-scoring governance indicators; equal socioeconomic opportunity fell 12.7 points over the same period to 53.6, one of the country's ten most deteriorated measures. Against that, a Swedish-funded programme teaching digital skills to secondary and vocational students, girls included, runs to 2026.

Data

National statistics

The capacity of Zimbabwe's statistical system was measured at 63.1 out of 100 in 2023, eleventh of 54 African states and up 21.0 points over the decade — the third most improved of all the governance indicators tracked for the country. What has improved is the handling of data rather than its collection. On the World Bank's Statistical Performance Indicators for 2023 the strongest pillar is data use, above 89%, with data products at 70-89%, data services and data infrastructure both in the 50-69% band, and data sources weakest at 20-49%. Data sources is the pillar everything else is built from: the censuses, surveys and administrative records that the products and the use draw on.

That weakness has a shape. A population census and a business census have been run within the last ten years, and no agricultural census within the last twenty. The survey programme mirrors it: three or more household, labour, health and agricultural surveys in the last decade, and no business survey in that period. The enterprise side of the economy is counted when a count is commissioned — ZIMSTAT's 2024/25 economic census is the recent instance — rather than on a maintained cycle.

Administrative data does not yet fill the gap. The financial management information system is used extensively to monitor government programme performance, but captures only some of the performance indicators and only for selected programmes (2025), and ZIMSTAT officials acknowledge that administrative data systems remain siloed and need further integration (2026). Labour is the sharpest instance: there is no integrated labour market information system, no central repository and no data-sharing policy among the agencies that produce employment data.

A measurement framework can also simply break. In the first quarter of 2025 POTRAZ recorded used international bandwidth of 2.69 Tbps against total equipped capacity of 1.43 Tbps, because Starlink — 83% of used bandwidth — has no Zimbabwean ground infrastructure to measure and sat outside the capacity table; from the second quarter the regulator excluded it and restated the baseline, making headline used bandwidth appear to collapse by 81% in a pure reclassification.

Open data

Disclosure of public records is among the fastest-improving things in Zimbabwe's governance record, up 19.4 points over 2014-2023 to 43.9 out of 100 and fifteenth of 54 African states, while the accessibility of those same records stayed near-flat at 34.5, twenty-first. More is disclosed; it is no easier to reach.

The digital government estate is the clearest case. The GovTech Maturity Index records none of it as published: not the digital transformation strategy documents, not the data governance documents, not the public-service digital skills strategy, not the work of the coordinating institution, not the government cloud hosting or data exchange arrangements, while the e-procurement documents, the data protection compliance reporting and the data protection authority's own reporting exist but are held internally (2025). Zimbabwe has an established data governance institution and no published account of what it does.

There is no central government open data portal (2025). What exists is agency publication: ZIMSTAT has run an SDMX-based statistical data exchange and an open data portal since mid-2025, the Reserve Bank issues a quarterly national payment systems report with editions up to the first quarter of 2026, and the Surveyor General's eCadastre allows nationwide online search of land parcels. Against that, public disclosure about how government exchanges data runs to POTRAZ's annual sector reports and limited ICT ministry documentation, with no public operational dashboard (2025).

The statistics themselves are open unevenly and thin at the top. Open Data Watch's 2024 inventory scores nothing higher than 7 out of 10, for international trade, with the built environment at 6.5 and agriculture, energy, natural resources, crime and education outcomes all at 3; several categories score zero, with no openly available data found in them. The pattern repeats wherever money is involved: ZIPIT's scheme rules are confidential and not published, and the Universal Services Fund is audited annually without a balance appearing in the report.

Nor is there any online facility through which the public can request government records (2025). The five-year National AI Strategy of March 2026 carries an open-data push, treating public data release as a component of AI readiness.

Use of satellite data

Zimbabwe's first national space regime is being written into a telecoms Act rather than a space Act: Clause 12 of the Postal and Telecommunications (Amendment) Bill, published in October 2025, would create a licensing gate over the country's ITU orbital resources and over the launch of space objects in Zimbabwe's name. The Bill is not in force, and no national space or geospatial data policy had been adopted, nor any government Earth observation programme set up, as at August 2026.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

The most visible American technology presence attached to Zimbabwe sits outside the country: Liquid C2, part of the Zimbabwean Econet Group, opened Africa's first Google Cloud Partner Experience Centre in Johannesburg rather than in Zimbabwe (June 2026). Zimbabweans front the programme it belongs to — Strive Masiyiwa and Google senior vice-president James Manyika appeared for the company's continent-wide cloud and AI jobs push at the Africa Cloud Summit (June 2026).

China activities

Chinese vendors sit inside Zimbabwe's identity estate rather than alongside it: Inspur and Sino Zimbabwe supply national data centre infrastructure and CloudWalk supplies facial recognition, with Laxton holding elections biometrics, Garsu Pasaulis holding passport and border biometrics and card production contracted out to a private printer, while the Registrar-General's Office and POTRAZ keep the core population registry in-country (2023).

The networks were built on Chinese state credit and Chinese equipment. China Eximbank concessional lending has carried NetOne, the wholly state-owned operator, from 2G to 3G and mobile broadband, buying Huawei equipment throughout (2021). For the fixed operator, the government took a China Eximbank preferential buyer's credit at 2% interest and on-lent it to TelOne at 5%, covering 85% of TelOne's US$116.8 million equipment contract with Huawei against TelOne's own 15%, with the state-owned NetOne standing guarantor and the first drawdown taken in March 2017 (2018). The two state operators' loans are tied to each other: TelOne must hold a minimum balance in a debt-service reserve account at China Eximbank, and where that account cannot meet interest and principal the agreement directs surplus revenues from the escrow account of the separately financed Phase 3 of NetOne's expansion to settle TelOne's debt, on a credit whose repayments run into the 2030s.

Chinese lending reaches the private market too: China Development Bank and ZTE Corporation agreed a US$300 million facility for Econet Wireless Zimbabwe on 4 December 2015, carved out of a larger line to the parent group. At the University of Zimbabwe, a Chinese-built high-performance computing centre was handed to the university on 6 February 2015 with dozens of Zimbabwean researchers trained to run it, and China's Ministry of Commerce then financed a second phase intended to raise its capacity almost tenfold and add cloud services, with Inspur Group as contractor (2018).

Five of the six external digital financing commitments recorded for Zimbabwe come from Chinese state lenders — China Development Bank, China Eximbank and the Ministry of Commerce — and between them they account for effectively all of the money committed (August 2026).

EU activities

The only European money on Zimbabwe's digital record is Swedish, and it buys teaching rather than infrastructure: Sida is financing a Plan International programme teaching digital literacy, coding and employability skills to secondary and vocational students, running to 2026. No European institution had financed infrastructure, supplied a government system or signed a bilateral digital agreement with Zimbabwe as at August 2026.

Gulf/UAE activities

No Gulf state investment in, or bilateral digital agreement covering, Zimbabwe's digital estate was on the record as at August 2026. The standing instrument is general: a promotion and reciprocal protection of investments agreement with the United Arab Emirates, signed in June 2018, approved by both Houses in September and October 2020 and ratified by the President on 28 November 2020. The two governments agreed in Dubai in February 2026 to conclude a comprehensive economic partnership agreement within three months, its proposed scope agriculture, mining, energy and infrastructure. Three months past that deadline the Emirati minister of state met the President in Harare on 10 August 2026 to discuss economy, investment and trade, with no agreement announced.

India activities

No Indian financing commitment, supplied system or bilateral digital agreement with Zimbabwe was on the record as at August 2026. India's own bilateral brief names a defence cooperation memorandum signed during a Zimbabwean ministerial visit to Aero India 2025, a joint commission agreement of 1987 and an air services agreement of 2014, and none of them touches digital transformation, information technology or data. What moved in the period was diplomatic: India pledged support for Zimbabwe's bid for a non-permanent Security Council seat for 2027-2028 and Zimbabwe for India's candidature for 2028-2029, reaffirmed in Harare on 26 January 2026.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-09-01**
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/ZWE/ZWE-status.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/ZWE/ZWE-status-2026-09-01.pdf
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